

KEEP THIS OPEN DURING HARD CONVERSATIONS

Phrases That Lower the Temperature

You don't need to be eloquent mid-conflict. You need three or four lines you can reach for automatically. Practice these before you need them.

WHEN YOU'RE ABOUT TO REACT

"I want to respond well to this. Give me a minute."

"I hear that you're upset. Say more."

WHEN YOU DISAGREE

"I see it differently, and I still want to understand your side."

"Let's slow down, what does [child's name] actually need here?"

WHEN YOU NEED SPACE

"I'm not able to talk about this productively right now. Can we pick it up at [specific time]?"

WHEN YOU'RE REPAIRING

"I was short with you earlier. That wasn't okay, regardless of what led up to it."

"Thank you for handling [specific thing], I noticed."